



Festivals

Halloween

- The following cultural notes describe both the origins and the current traditions of this festival. Explain as much as you feel is relevant to the class.
- Halloween is celebrated on October 31st in the United Kingdom, the United States, Canada, Australia, New Zealand, and many other countries around the world. It is not a public holiday, but it is a very important celebration for children. The word "Halloween" originally came from *All Hallow's Eve*, which means the evening before the Day of the Holy Ones or All Saints' Day, November 1st. The tradition is that, on this night, spirits, ghosts, and witches wander the earth. People used to make lanterns out of pumpkins and place them in the window to scare away these frightening creatures.
- Nowadays, on the night of Halloween, children get dressed up as witches, ghosts, vampires, and other scary monsters, and have a costume party. Items that are traditionally associated with Halloween are pumpkin lanterns, bats, spiders, and black cats. Children often play a traditional game called "apple bobbing." They have to bite an apple that is floating in water or hanging on a string. Typical party food is cupcakes and pizza decorated with horrible faces!
- On Halloween, children love to play *Trick or Treat*. They knock on neighbors' doors and ask *Trick or Treat*? If the neighbor chooses a treat, he/she has to offer the children candy or chocolate. If not, the children will play a naughty trick, like using a water pistol! It's always a good idea to have treats ready for visitors on Halloween!

Halloween worksheet 1

- Students read the sentences about bats and decide whether they are true or false. Students work in groups. They compare their answers and decide on a group answer. Give marks to each group for correct answers.
 - Students need scissors and elastic. Note: It is a good idea to photocopy the template onto thin cardboard. Alternatively it could be glued or stapled to a strip of thin cardboard.
 - Students color the bat black and cut along the dotted line to make a mask. They then thread elastic through the holes.
- Key:** 1 F, 2 F, 3 F (bats and mice belong to different families), 4 T, 5 F (they have one every year), 6 F (70 percent are insectivores; the rest eat pollen and fruit. The vampire bats of Latin America eat blood – you can decide whether or not to tell the students about the blood!).
- **Optional follow-up activity:** Students all wear their masks and stand in a row. One student takes off his/her mask and stands apart. Point to a masked student and ask *Who is it?* The student without the mask names him/her.

Halloween worksheet 2

- Students look at the magic spell, count how many of each item the witch has, and then write how many she needs to buy. They invent a reason for the magic spell.
- Key:** 2 frogs, 3 lizards, 2 spiders, 5 eyes, 4 snakes.
Suggested reasons for magic spell: To make her cat green. To be young and beautiful.
- **Optional follow-up activity:** Students invent new magic spells and what they are for. They can draw the ingredients.



Festivals

Christmas

- The following cultural notes describe both the origins and the current traditions of this festival. Explain as much as you feel is relevant to the class.
- Christmas Day is celebrated in countries around the world on December 25th, to commemorate the birth of Jesus. In the weeks before Christmas, people decorate a Christmas tree with ornaments. They usually put a star on the top to remind them of the story of the birth of Jesus and the Three Wise Men. People also like to send each other Christmas cards with typical Christmas scenes and a Christmas message. Younger children write a letter to Santa Claus, or Father Christmas as he is sometimes called, to tell him what they would like for Christmas. On Christmas Eve, December 24th, they hang a Christmas stocking at the end of their bed or by the fireplace, if they have one. Traditionally, Santa Claus arrives in his sleigh pulled by reindeer. He flies through the air, lands on the roofs of children's houses, and delivers the presents by climbing down the chimneys with a huge sack of presents!
- On Christmas Day, families get together to eat a traditional meal. This usually consists of roast turkey, with vegetables. Dessert is often a rich fruit pudding served with a brandy sauce that is set alight! The table is decorated with candles and brightly colored crackers. Everyone pulls the crackers, which make a loud bang. Children love to look inside the crackers to find a colorful paper Christmas hat, a small toy, and a Christmas joke.

Christmas worksheet 1

- Students need brown, gray, and red pens or pencils, scissors, and glue.
- Students follow the instructions to make a Christmas robin decoration.
- **Optional follow-up activity:** Tell the class the legend about the robin's red breast. In the old days, robins were only brown and white. When Jesus was born, he was very cold. The fire was going out, and the Virgin Mary was too tired to blow on the embers. She asked the oxen, but they said no. She asked the donkey, but he said no. A robin came into the stable. The robin started flapping his wings to make some heat for the baby. A spark from the fire landed on the robin's breast and turned it red. Jesus was warm, so the Virgin Mary said that, from then on, robins could always have red breasts.

Ask the students if they know any legends about other animals.

Christmas worksheet 2

- Students need three cardboard toilet roll cylinders, crepe or tissue paper, thread, stickers, Scotch tape, and scissors.
- Students follow the instructions to make a Christmas cracker. Help them understand the joke ("rain, dear" sounds like "reindeer," the animal that pulls Santa's sleigh. "Dear" is a term of endearment often used by older people).
- **Optional follow-up activity:** Students tell Christmas jokes. Help them say them in English. Suggestions for Christmas jokes: What falls in the North Pole, but never gets hurt? Snow! What do monkeys sing at Christmas? Jungle Bells!



Festivals

Easter

- The following cultural notes describe both the origins and current traditions of this festival. Explain as much as you feel is relevant to the class.
- Easter celebrates the resurrection of Jesus in the Christian religion. Easter Sunday always falls in the spring. However, the date is fixed according to the lunar calendar and therefore differs slightly every year. In the weeks before Easter, people send Easter cards to friends and family, and they buy chocolate Easter eggs and Easter bunnies for their children. Many children like to boil real eggs and then paint them with bright colors. Children often have egg rolling competitions or hold Easter egg hunts with the colorful eggs. Easter baskets are associated with Easter. People fill them with Easter eggs and spring flowers to decorate their houses.
- In the United Kingdom, people like to eat hot cross buns with a lot of butter at Easter. These pastries are marked with a cross, which represents the Christian cross, and were traditionally eaten during Lent. In the Middle Ages, bakers would sell these buns in the streets. Of course, Easter is a time when a lot of people like to go to church. It is an important time of the year and Good Friday and Easter Monday are public holidays.

Easter worksheet 1

- Students need green and yellow pens or pencils, scissors, and a yellow egg carton section. Note: It is a good idea to photocopy the template onto thin cardboard and to enlarge it, if possible.
- Students follow the instructions to make an Easter card.
- **Optional follow-up activity:** Tell the students that the daffodil is the national flower of Wales. Show them where Wales is on a map. You could use the map on page 70.

Easter worksheet 2

- Students need an egg, markers, some paper towel and cotton balls, mustard, and cress seeds. Note: If appropriate, send a note to parents so that students crack, wash, and dry the egg at home.
- Students follow the instructions to make an egg head.
- **Optional follow-up activity:** Students keep a diary about the growth of the seeds, or "hair." Help them with this. For example:
Week/day 1. I water the seeds.
Week/day 2. The seeds are growing.
Week/day 3. I can see the plant. It looks like hair!



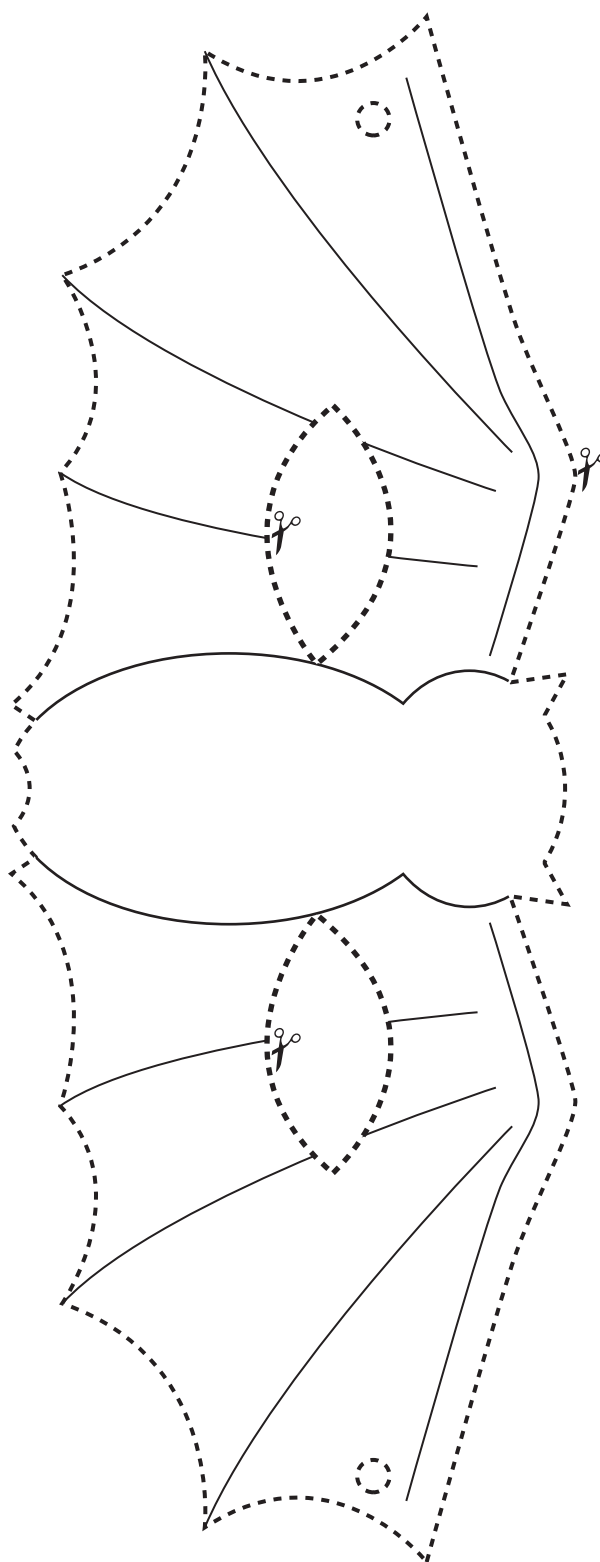
Halloween worksheet 1



Read and think. Check true (T) or False (F).

- | | | |
|--|----------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 1 Bats can't see. | T ☐ | F ☒ |
| 2 Bats can't hear. | T ☐ | F ☐ |
| 3 Bats are flying mice. | T ☐ | F ☐ |
| 4 Bats can live more than 20 years. | T ☐ | F ☐ |
| 5 Mother bats usually have five babies every year. | T ☐ | F ☐ |
| 6 Thirty percent of bats eat insects. | T ☐ | F ☐ |

Make a bat mask.

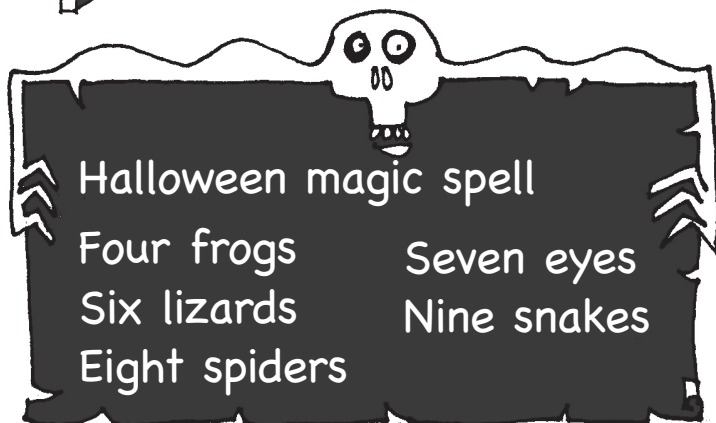
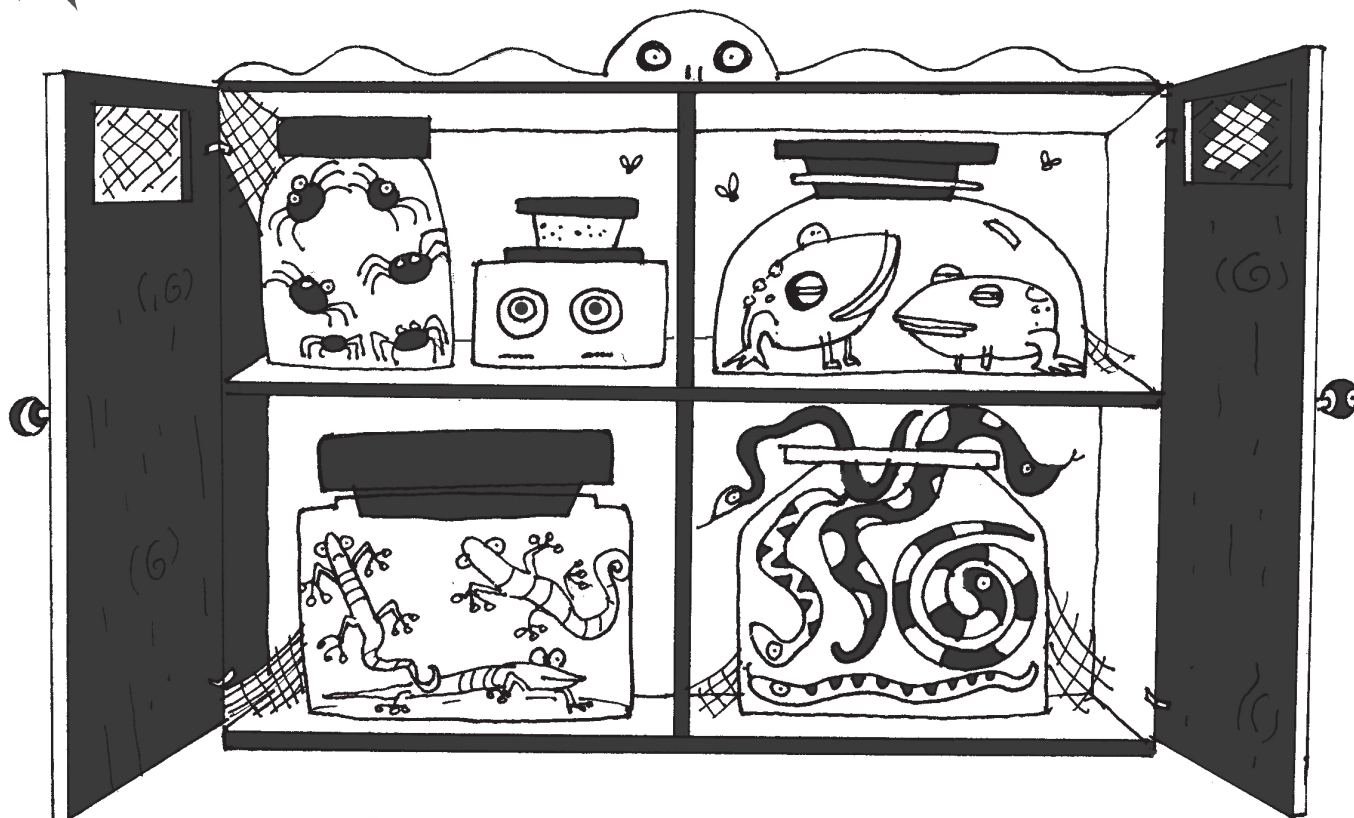




Halloween worksheet 2



Count and write.



What does the witch need to buy for her magic spell? She needs to buy

.....Two..... frogs eyes
..... lizards snakes
..... spiders



What is the magic spell for?

To
.....



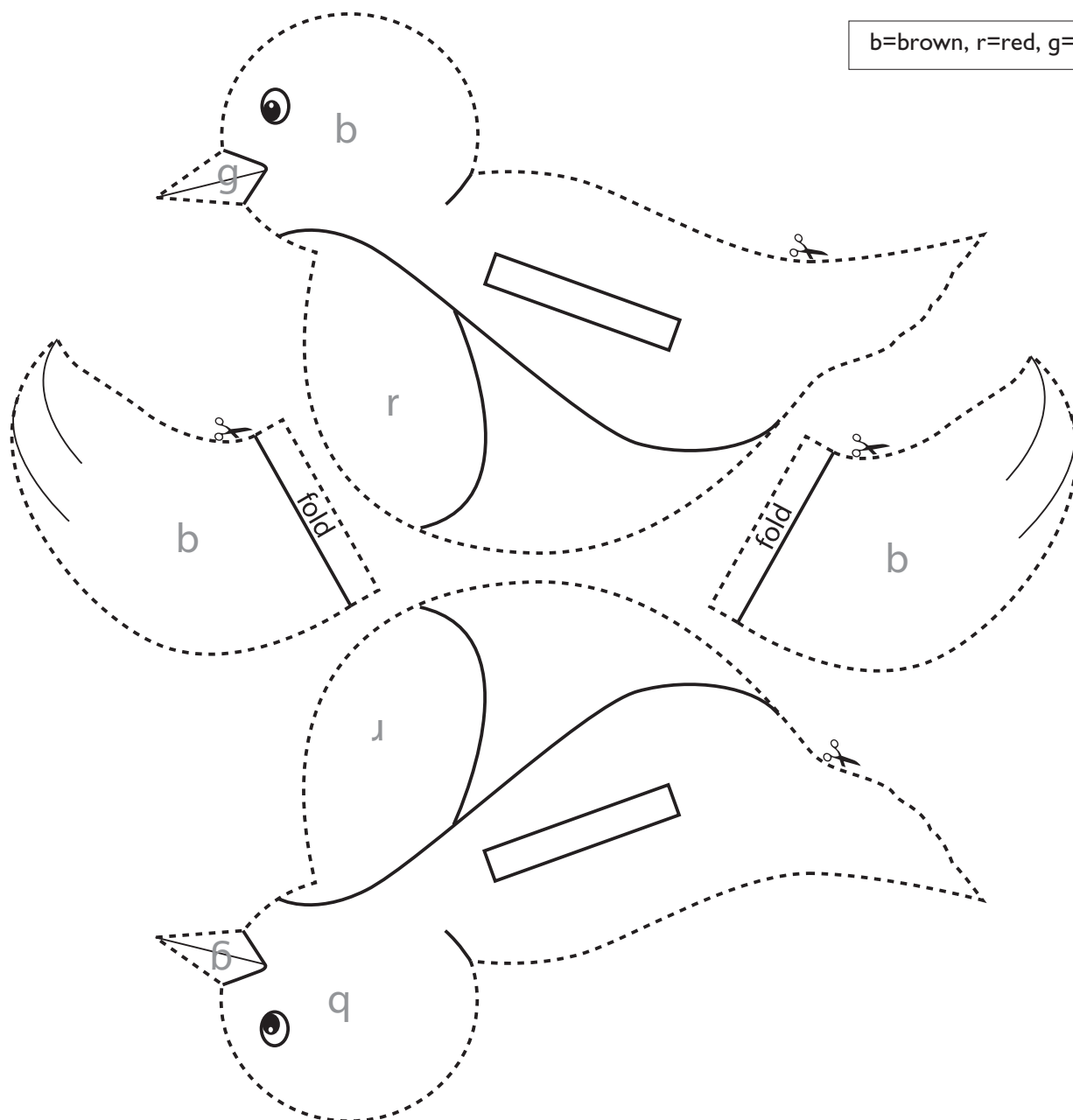
Christmas worksheet 1



Read and make.

A Christmas decoration

- Color the robins.
- Cut along the dotted lines.
- Glue the two halves together, inserting a straw between the two halves.
- Fold the top of the wings and glue them to the robin.



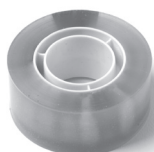


Christmas worksheet 2

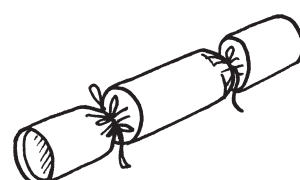
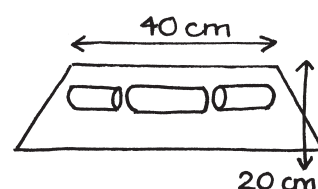


Read and make.

A Christmas cracker



- Make a paper hat with crepe or tissue paper.
- Cut out the joke.
- Put the hat and the joke inside a cardboard cylinder.
- Place another cylinder on each side of this one.
- Cut a piece of crepe or tissue paper 40 cm x 20 cm.
- Roll the crepe or tissue paper around the three cylinders.
- Tie thread between the cylinders.
- Take out the two end cylinders.
- Decorate the cracker with stickers.
- Pull it!



MERRY CHRISTMAS!



Santa Claus: *What's the weather like?*
Mrs. Claus: *It looks like rain, dear.*



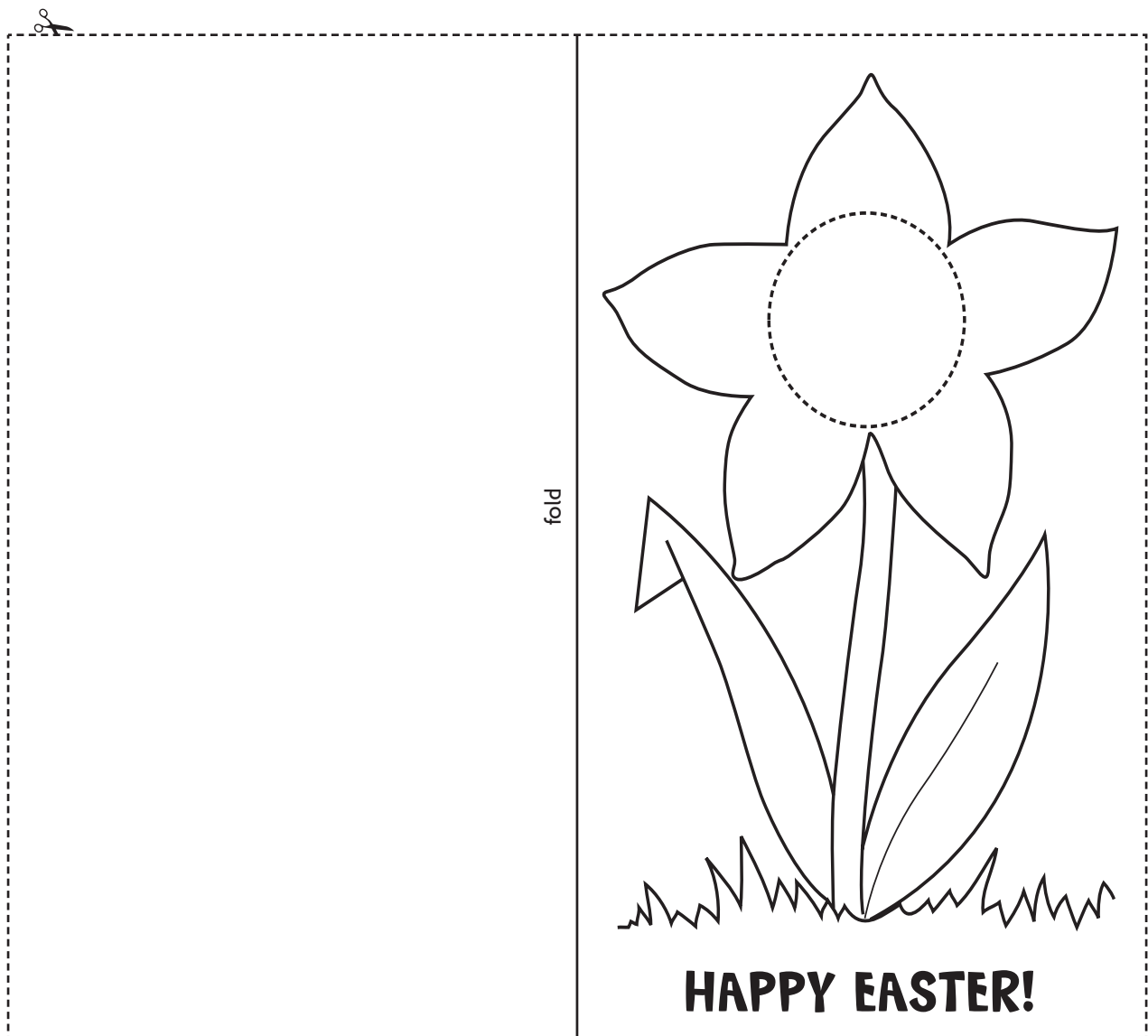
Easter worksheet 1



Read and make.

An Easter card

- Color the grass, stem, and leaves green.
- Color the daffodil flower yellow.
- Cut along the dotted line, then fold the card in half.
- Cut out a yellow egg carton section. If it's another color, color it yellow.
- Stick it in the middle of the flower to make the trumpet.





Easter worksheet 2



Read and make.



On Easter, people give Easter eggs. You can make one with hair!

- Crack an egg near the top.
- Wash it and dry it.
- Use felt tip pens to draw a face.
- Put wet paper towel and then wet cotton balls in the egg.
- Put mustard and cress seeds on the cotton balls.
- Put the egg in a warm light place.
- Wait a few days or a week. Keep the cotton balls damp.
- The seeds will grow and look like hair!

